

Weather

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training

Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Future forms	Talking about the weather
Question tags	Vocabulary and Phrases

CLA-CLI
Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
Excellence in Linguistic Training



Future Forms

There is not just one "Future Tense" in English. We use several different forms to talk about the future. When we know about the future, we normally use the **present tenses**.

The most common are:

Present Simple	John arrives in about half-an-hour from now.
Present Continuous	Sam is working in Singapore next week.
Be going to + base form	They're going to build a new shopping centre here.
Modal will + base form (Future Simple)	I think they will postpone the football match.
Modals may, might, could + base form	They might come for dinner tomorrow.
Modal should + base form	Sarah should pass her exam: she has studied a lot!

Present Simple for the Future

We use the Present Simple for **something scheduled**:

John arrives in about half-an-hour from now.

We have a tennis lesson next Wednesday.

The plane leaves at 8:30 am.

Tim's job starts at the beginning of next week.

Tomorrow is your birthday!

The flight departs from Gate 56.

Present Continuous for the Future

We use the Present Continuous for **plans or arrangements**:

Sam is working in Singapore next week.

We're playing football on Saturday.

They are coming to see us at the weekend.

We're having a party at New Year's.

What are you doing on Saturday evening?

Sarah and Jane are meeting me at the station.

Be Going To (Intentional Future) for the Future

We use Be Going To + base form to talk about **plans or intentions**:

They're going to build a new shopping centre here.

I'm going to drive to work today.

Who are you going to invite to the party?

We use Be Going To + base form to **make predictions** based on evidence we can see:

Be careful! You are going to fall. (*I can see that you might fall*)

Look at those black clouds. I think it's going to rain. (*I can see that it will rain*)

Tom missed his train. He is going to be late for work. (*He missed his train, so he will be late*)

Modal Will for the Future (Future Simple)

We use Will + base form to express **beliefs** about the future:

I think they will postpone the football match.

It will be a nice day tomorrow.

We use Will + base form to mean **want to** or **be willing to**:

I hope Tony will come to my party.

Jeremy says he will help us.

We use Will + base form to **make offers and promises**:

I'll see you tomorrow morning.

They'll send me a fax.

We use Will + base form to **talk about offers and promises**:

Thomas will be at the match.

Sally will help with the decorating.

Modals May, Might, Could for the Future

We use May, Might and Could + base form when we are **not sure** about the future:

I may go on holiday to Italy, but I haven't decided yet.

Take an umbrella with you. It may rain later.

They might come for dinner tomorrow evening.

She might get home late this evening.

We could see Jennifer at the wedding.

When you go to Paris, next month, you could stay with Alex.

Modal Should for the Future

We use Should + base form if we think there's a **good chance** of something happening:

Sarah should pass her exam: she has studied a lot!

The film should be over by six o'clock.

My parents should arrive in a few minutes.

They should win the game because they are a much better team.

I posted the letter yesterday, so it should arrive this week.

It should be good weather tomorrow.

Question Tags

Question tags (or tag questions) turn a **statement** into a **question**.

They are often used for checking information that **we think we know is true**.

Question tags are made using an **auxiliary verb** (for example: be or have) and a **subject pronoun** (for example: I, you, she).

Usually **if the main clause is positive**, the **question tag is negative**, **and if the main clause is negative**, the **question tag is positive**.

For example: **It's** cold (positive), **isn't it** (negative)? **OR** **It isn't** cold (negative), **is it** (positive)?

Question Tags

If the main clause **has an auxiliary verb** in it, you use **the same verb in the tag question**.

If there is **no auxiliary verb** (as in the present simple and past simple) **use do / does / did** (just like when you make a normal question).

There is one bizarre exception: **the question tag after I am is aren't I**?

For example: I'm going to be singing at the talent show, aren't I?

Negative question tags are usually **contracted**: It's cold today, isn't it? (not 'is it not')

Question Tags

Positive sentences with negative tags

Present simple BE	She's English, isn't she?
Present simple other verbs	They live in Rome, don't they?
Present continuous	You're working on Saturday, aren't you?
Past simple BE	It was hot yesterday, wasn't it?
Past simple other verbs	Mike went to the theatre last night, didn't he?
Past continuous	They were waiting at the pub, weren't they?
Present perfect	She's been to Japan, hasn't she?
Present perfect continuous	He's been studying a lot recently, hasn't he?
Future simple	They'll come at seven, won't they?
Modal CAN	We can help, can't we?
Modal MUST	John must stay, mustn't he?

Question Tags

Negative sentences with positive tags

Present simple BE	We aren't late, are we?
Present simple other verbs	Serena doesn't have any dogs, does she?
Present continuous	The bus isn't coming, is it?
Past simple BE	He wasn't at school yesterday, was he?
Past simple other verbs	They didn't go out last night, did they?
Past continuous	You weren't sleeping, were you?
Present perfect	The dog hasn't eaten all the steak, has it?
Present perfect continuous	She hasn't been running under this rain, has she?
Future simple	You won't be late, will you?
Modal CAN	She can't speak Japanese, can she?
Modal MUST	Jonathan mustn't come early, must he?